

Simulated Incident Report — #4

Wazuh / Suricata Detection Lab

01 Alert Summary

INCIDENT #	SIM-004	DATE / TIME	Aug 12, 2026 @ 01:00:39.856
ATTACK TYPE	Unauthorized Local Account/Group Creation	SEVERITY	Medium severity, Rule Level 8
SOURCE	Local (root-privileged session)	DESTINATION	54.84.165.65 (VM)
DETECTING TOOL	Wazuh — "New group added to the system" rule, system account monitoring		

02 Initial Triage

Detection triggered by the generation of a local user and group (backdooruser). Primary triage centered on determining if the creation correlated with an authorized change request or legitimate administrative workflow. While the naming convention was intentionally simulated for this exercise to represent a persistence mechanism, the investigative requirement remains consistent: any unverified account generation requires immediate verification against established provisioning records.

03 Investigation Steps

Verified the addition of a new user and group by reviewing /etc/passwd and correlating the Wazuh FIM event. Checked the alert timeline for surrounding sudo or privilege-escalation activity to identify if the creation followed a broader compromise. Confirmed the account remained at default, non-privileged levels and was not granted membership in administrative groups like sudo or wheel.

04 Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE

FALSE POSITIVE

Confirmed creation of an account not tied to any approved provisioning process (simulated for this exercise). In this lab context, verdict reflects the exercise design; in production, verdict would depend on cross-referencing change management records.

05 MITRE ATT&CK

TECH ID#	NAME	TACTIC
T1136.001	Create Account: Local Account	Persistence

06 Escalation

Incident resolved at Tier 1 for this controlled lab simulation, as the account creation was an authorized part of the exercise. In a live production setting, this event would trigger immediate escalation to Tier 2/IR; unexpected local account generation represents a high-confidence indicator of attacker persistence, designed to sustain unauthorized access beyond the remediation of the primary intrusion vector.

07 Response / Remediation

Account removed (userdel -r backdooruser) following verification. In production: would disable (not immediately delete) the account pending investigation to preserve forensic artifacts, audit group memberships and file ownership tied to the account, and review authentication logs for any activity performed under it before removal.

08 Lessons Learned / Tuning

Verified that Wazuh reliably identifies local account and group generation natively, providing a robust default mechanism for surfacing T1136.001 persistence. Integrating this detection with group-membership or sudoers monitoring would streamline the triage process, helping analysts quickly determine if new accounts acquired administrative rights and therefore require immediate high-severity escalation.